

Trajectory planning for robot manipulators and grasping

Aljaz Kramberger

alk@mmmi.sdu.dk

SDU Robotics

The Maersk Mc-Kinney Moller Institute
University of Southern Denmark

Aljaz Kramberger

Associate Professor

Email: alk@mmmi.sdu.dk

Office: Ø27-602a-3

SDU Robotics, The Maersk Mc-Kinney Moller Institute.

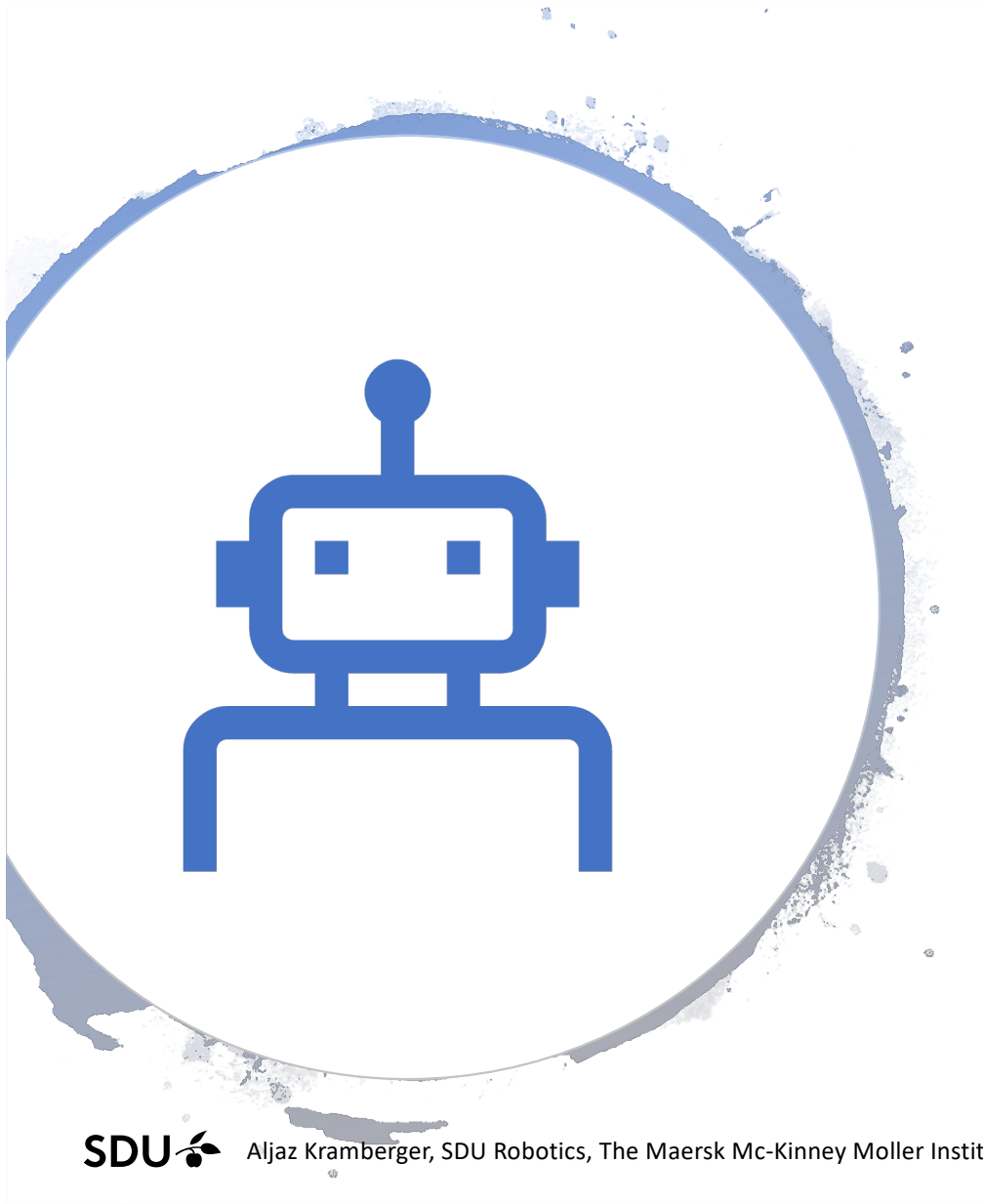
M.Sc – Mechatronics,

Ph.D – Robotics (robot control in contact with the environment)

Research filed:

- Robot control, learning, human robot interaction, industrial robotics,
- Part design and optimization,
- Robot grasping





Agenda

- Interpolation for trajectories represented in Cartesian space
- Cubic polynomial interpolation
- Defining trajectories by Learning
- Robotic grasping

Additional material

- Siciliano, Bruno, Oussama Khatib, and Torsten Kröger, eds. *Springer handbook of robotics*. Vol. 200. Berlin: springer, 2008.
- Siciliano, Bruno, Lorenzo Sciavicco, Luigi Villani, and Giuseppe Oriolo. *Robotics: modelling, planning and control*. Springer Science & Business Media, 2010.
- Mihelj, Matjaž, Tadej Bajd, Aleš Ude, Jadran Lenarčič, Aleš Stanovnik, Marko Munih, Jure Rejc, and Sebastjan Šlajpah. *Robotics*. Springer, Cham, 2019.

Trajectory's

General we distinguish...



Joint
trajectories



Tool
trajectories

Differences

- Joint trajectories are presented as:

- $Trj_{joint} = \{q_i^1, q_i^2, \dots, q_i^n, t_i\}_{i=1}^{T,n}$, $t_i, i = 1, \dots, T_i$ are the number of samples and n number of joints.
- can directly be send to the robot.
- precise deterministic execution – (better tracking),
- the movement is not necessary linear although it was constructed such.

- Tool trajectories are presented as:

- $Trj_{tool} = \{p_i, o_i, t_i\}_{i=1}^T$ where $p = (p_x, p_y, p_z)$ is the positional part and $o = \mathbf{R}$ orientational part of the trajectory.
- Invers kinematics is needed in order to execute the trajectory.

Trajectory construction

- Trajectories can be constructed in different ways:
 - trajectories can be acquired with demonstration,
 - simple construction with point to point interpolation,
 - splines and polynomials,
 - using dynamic systems,
 - etc.

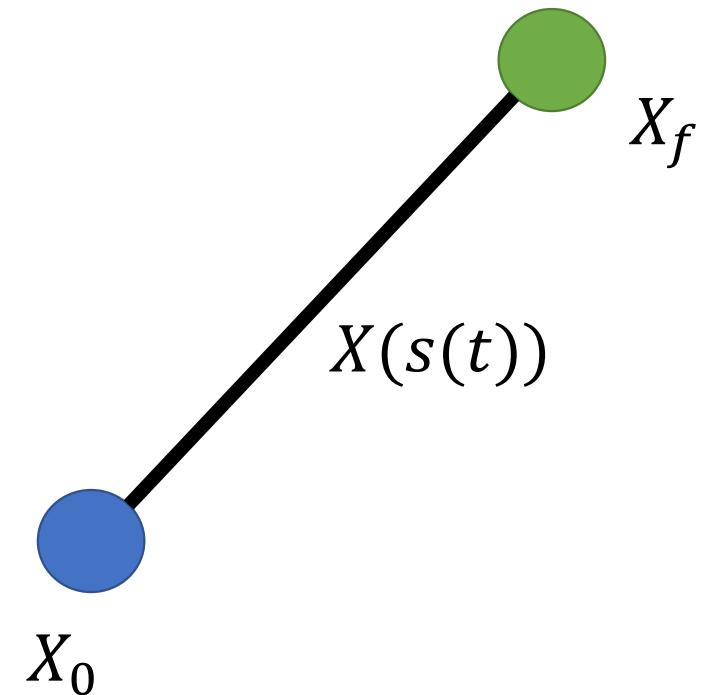
Linear interpolation

Linear interpolation

- Let's consider two vectors X_0 and X_f . A linear interpolation between them is given as:

$$X(s(t)) = X_0 + (X_f - X_0)s(t) \quad 0 \leq s \leq 1$$

- where $s(t)$ denotes a non decreasing continuous time profile satisfying:
 - $s(t_0) = 0$ at start,
 - $s(t_f) = 1$ at the end of the movement.



Linear interpolation

- We can also define a linear interpolator in joint space:

$$q^i(t) = q_o^i + \frac{t - t_0}{t_f - t_0} (q_f^i - q_o^i), i = 1, \dots, \text{numDOF}$$

- It is given by a first order polynomial, for better results higher order polynomials work better:
 - the problem of velocity – discontinuity and unbounded acceleration in both ends.
- the outcome, compared with tool space interpolation is not equal!!!!
- therefore, we have to carefully consider which type of interpolation is appropriate for the desired task/application.

Linear interpolation

- For velocity we will consider the following:

$$s(t) = \frac{t - t_0}{t_f - t_0} \text{ (constant velocity)}$$

$$s(t) = \left(\frac{t - t_0}{t_f - t_0} \right)^2 \text{ (linear ramp - up of velocity)}$$

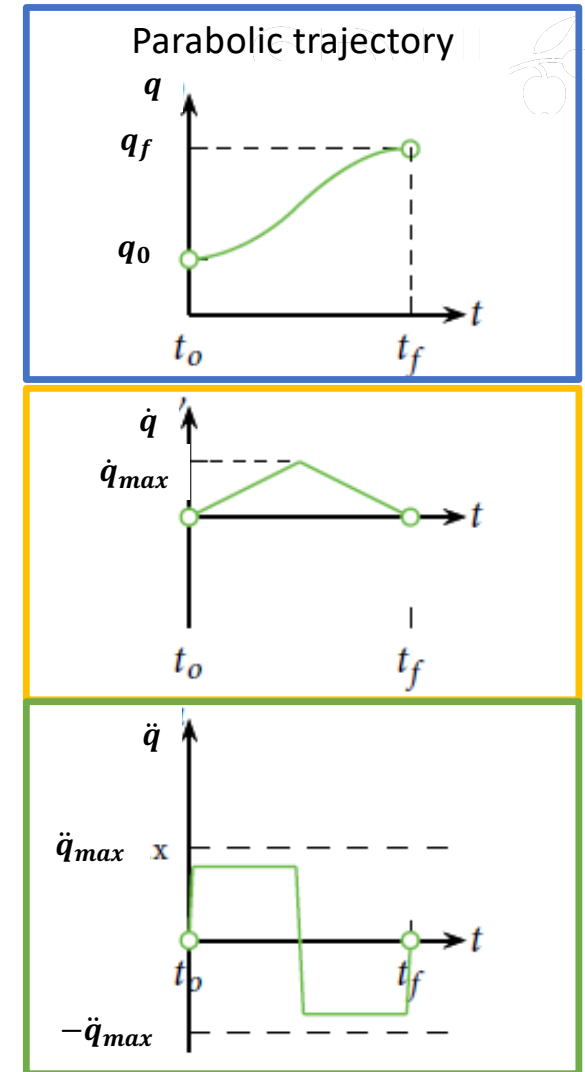
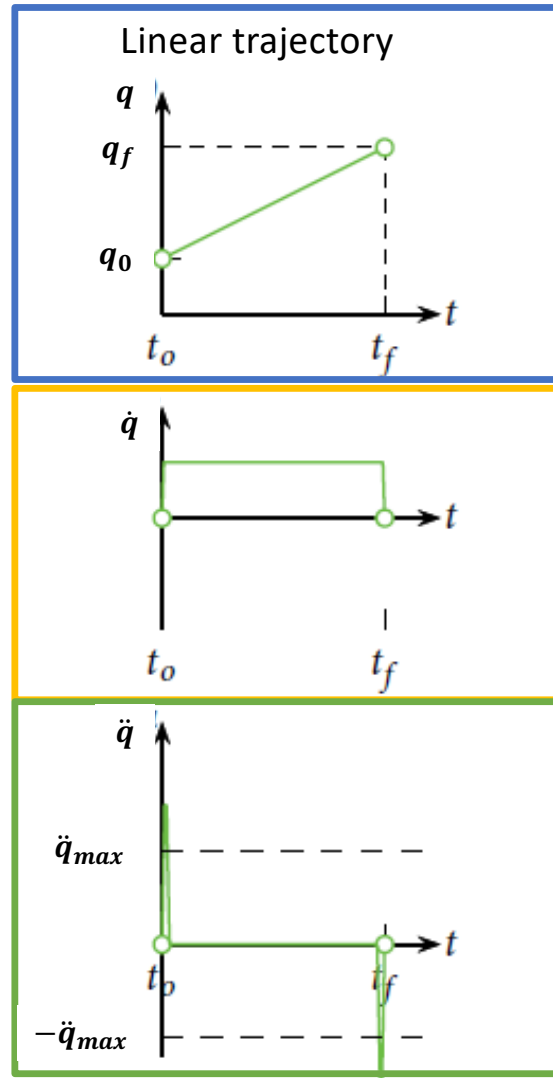
$$s(t) = 1 - \left(\frac{t - t_0}{t_f - t_0} \right)^2 \text{ (linear ramp - down of velocity)}$$

Trajectories

POSITION

VELOCITY

ACCELERATION

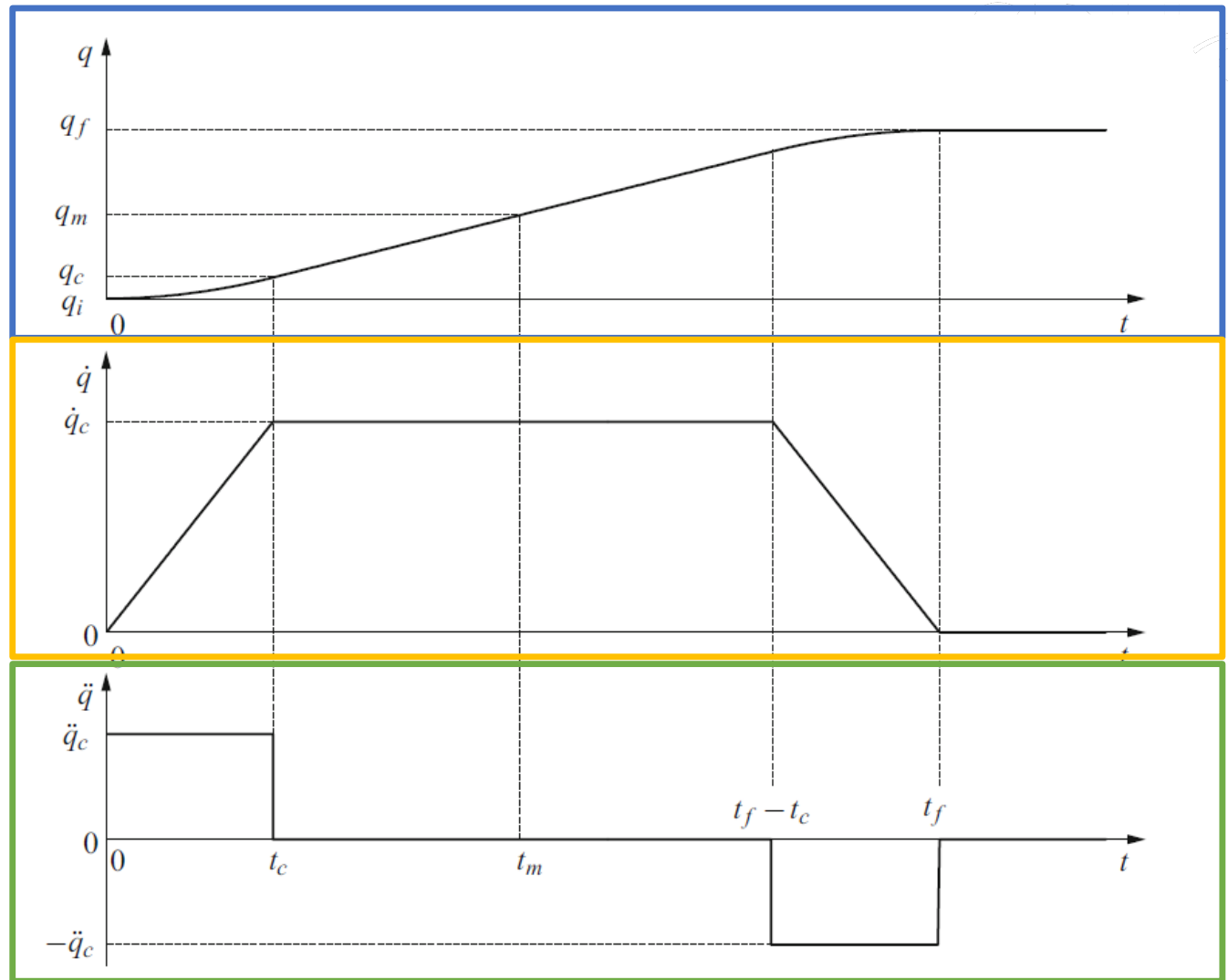


Linear interpolation

POSITION

VELOCITY

ACCELERATION



Parabolic blend in Task space

- Parabolic blend in task space, can for the positional part be calculated in the same way as for joint space parabolic blends.
- Orientation can be computed with piece wise computing slerp trajectories in quaternion space (more info *Dantam N, Stilman M. Spherical parabolic blends for robot workspace trajectories. In 2014 IEEE/RSJ International Conference on Intelligent Robots and Systems 2014 Sep 14 (pp. 3624-3629)*).
- Followed by solving the inverse kinematics for the generated task space path.

Quaternions

- Quaternions allow stable and constant interpolation of orientations
- Compact(-ish) representation
- Also easy to concatenate
- Faster multiplication algorithms to combine successive rotations than using rotation matrices
- Easier to normalize than rotation matrices
- Mathematically stable – suitable for statistics
- Given an angle and axis, easy to convert to and from quaternion

Definition

- We can extend complex numbers to 3-dimensional space by adding two imaginary numbers to our number system in addition to i
- Quaternions have 4 dimensions (each quaternion consists of 4 scalar numbers), one real dimension and 3 imaginary dimensions.
- Each of these imaginary dimensions has a unit value of the square root of -1, but they are different square roots of -1 all mutually perpendicular to each other, known as i , j and k .
- We can represent 3D rotations as 3 numbers (e.g. Euler angles) but such a representation is non-linear and difficult to work with.
- An analogy of a two dimensional map of the earth

Definition

- A quaternion can be represented as follows:

$$q = w + x\mathbf{i} + y\mathbf{j} + z\mathbf{k} \quad s, x, y, z \in \mathbb{R}$$

- Various annotation can be used:

$$\begin{aligned} q &= [w, \mathbf{v}] \\ &= [w, x\mathbf{i} + y\mathbf{j} + z\mathbf{k}] \\ &= w + x\mathbf{i} + y\mathbf{j} + z\mathbf{k} \end{aligned}$$

- In literature scalar and vector part are sometimes flipped $q = [\mathbf{v}, w]$

Quaternion interpolation

Linear interpolation

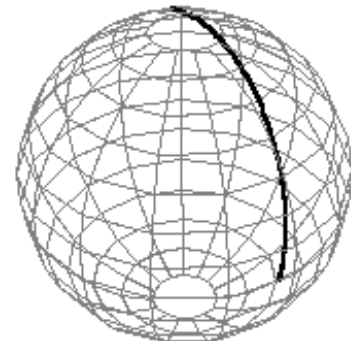
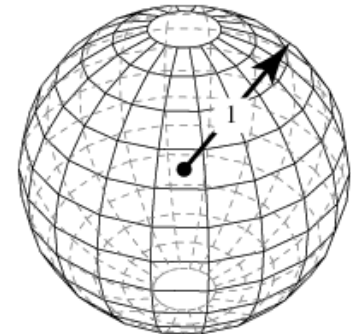
- Interpolation is used to determine intermediate points between two given points Q_1 and Q_2
- Linear interpolation can be used to do interpolation in normal space
- The standard linear interpolation formula is

$$Q^i = Q_1 + t(Q_2 - Q_1)$$

- The general steps to apply this equation are:
 - Compute the difference between Q_1 and Q_2
 - Take the fractional part of that difference
 - Adjust the original value by the fractional difference between the two points

Unit sphere

- A quaternion is a point on the 4-D unit sphere
- If we want to interpolate between two points on a sphere, we do not just want to Lerp between them
- Instead, we will travel across the surface of the sphere by following a great arc
- Move with constant angular velocity along the great circle between the two points
- There are two SLERP choices on a sphere
 - we pick the shortest

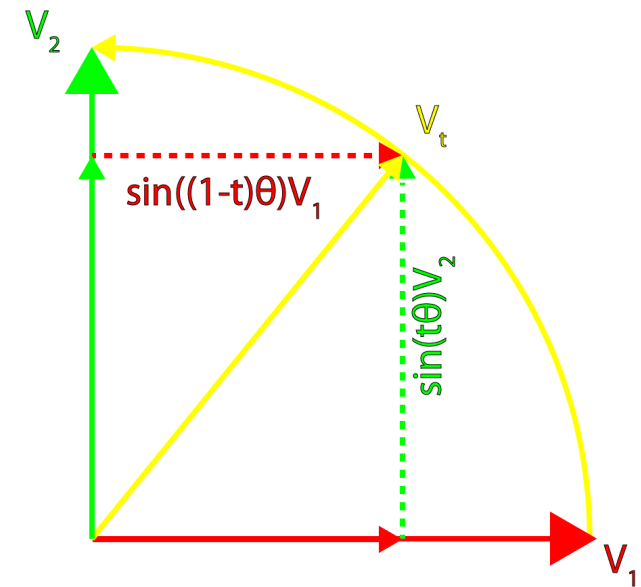


Source: Wolfram Research

Spherical interpolation of vectors

- We will apply a spherical interpolation of vectors to quaternions
- The general form of a spherical interpolation for vectors is defined as:

$$\mathbf{v}_t = \frac{\sin(1-t)\theta}{\sin \theta} \mathbf{v}_2 + \frac{\sin t\theta}{\sin \theta} \mathbf{v}_1$$



Spherical interpolation of quaternions

- The formula for spherical interpolation of vectors can be applied unmodified to quaternions:

$$Q_t = \frac{\sin(1-t)\theta}{\sin \theta} Q_2 + \frac{\sin t\theta}{\sin \theta} Q$$

- Angle θ need to be calculated

Spherical interpolation - angle θ

- We can obtain the angle θ by computing the dot-product between Q_1 and Q_2

$$\cos \theta = \frac{Q_1 \cdot Q_2}{|Q_1||Q_2|} = \frac{w_1 w_2 + x_1 x_2 + y_1 y_2 + z_1 z_2}{|Q_1||Q_2|}$$

$$\theta = \cos^{-1} \left(\frac{w_1 w_2 + x_1 x_2 + y_1 y_2 + z_1 z_2}{|Q_1||Q_2|} \right)$$

Spherical interpolation - considerations

- The quaternion dot-product can result in a negative value
-> the resulting interpolation will travel the long-way around the 4D sphere
- If the result of the dot product is negative, then we can negate one of the orientations
- Negating the scalar and the vector part of the quaternion does not change the orientation that it represents

Spherical interpolation - considerations

- If the angular difference θ between Q_1 and Q_2 is very small then $\sin \theta$ becomes 0 $\rightarrow$ undefined result when we divide by $\sin \theta$.
- In this case, we can fall-back to using linear interpolation between Q_1 and Q_2 .
- As changes are small a straight line is close to the arc on the sphere

Quaternion difference

- quaternion logarithm which maps $S^3 \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^3$ is defined as:

$$\mathbf{r} = \log(Q) = \log(v + \mathbf{u}) = \begin{cases} \arccos(v) \frac{\mathbf{u}}{\|\mathbf{u}\|}, \mathbf{u} \neq 0 \\ [0,0,0]^T, \text{ otherwise} \end{cases}$$

- which can be interpreted as a difference vector $\log(\mathbf{Q}_2 * \overline{\mathbf{Q}_1})$ between 2 unit quaternions.
- its inverse, the exponential map, which maps from $\mathbb{R}^3 \rightarrow S^3$ is defined:

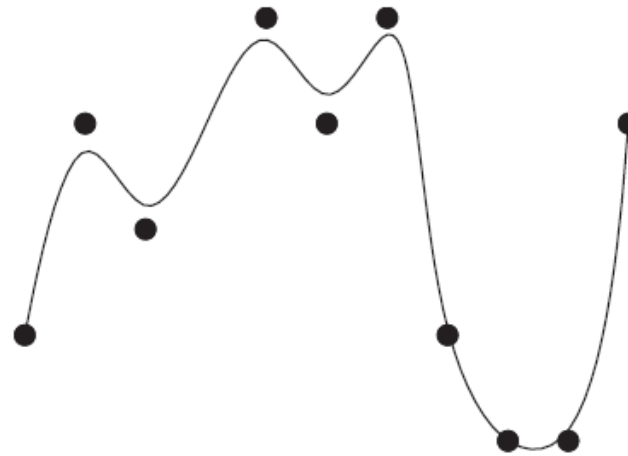
$$\exp(\mathbf{r}) = \begin{cases} \cos(\|\mathbf{r}\|) + \sin(\|\mathbf{r}\|) \frac{\mathbf{r}}{\|\mathbf{r}\|}, \mathbf{r} \neq 0 \\ 0, \text{ otherwise} \end{cases}$$

From Points, via- points to trajectories

From Points, via- points to trajectories



Interpolation



Approximation

- Definition: Interpolation Constructing new data points within the range of a discrete set of known data points (exact fitting).
- Definition: Approximation Inexact fitting of a discrete set of known data points.

Interpolation between points

- In comparison, velocities and accelerations are better approximated with the parabolic blends.
- Still this method does not give a completely smooth trajectory!
- For this we must look at the derivative of the acceleration at blend points.

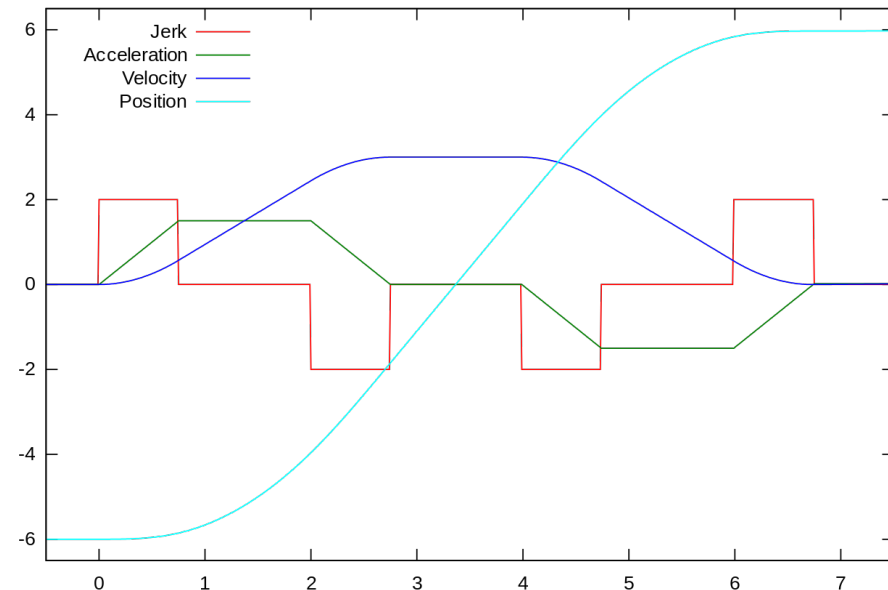
Definition of jerk for motion planning

- Jerk in motion control is the rate at which an object's acceleration changes with respect to time.
- It is a vector quantity (having both magnitude and direction). and expressed in m/s^3 (SI units).

- Jerk can be calculated as:

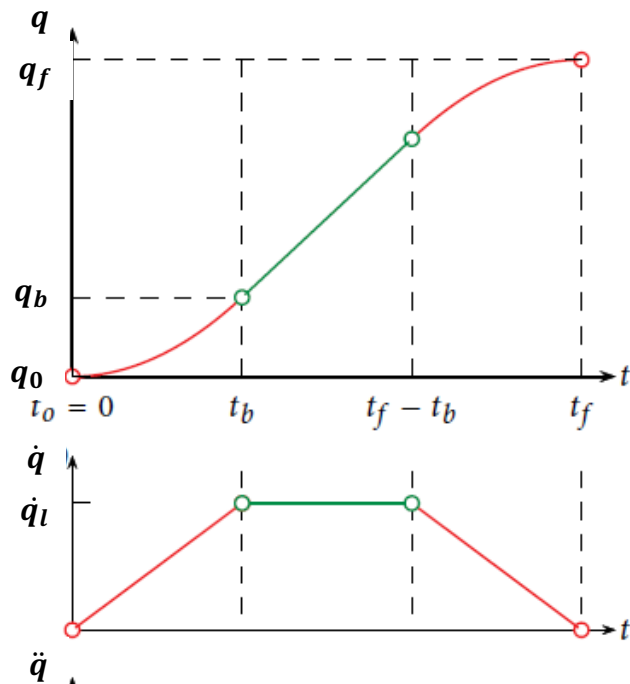
$$\vec{j} = \frac{da(t)}{dt} = \frac{d^2v(t)}{dt} = \frac{d^3q(t)}{dt}$$

- jerk can be calculated for joint and task space trajectories.

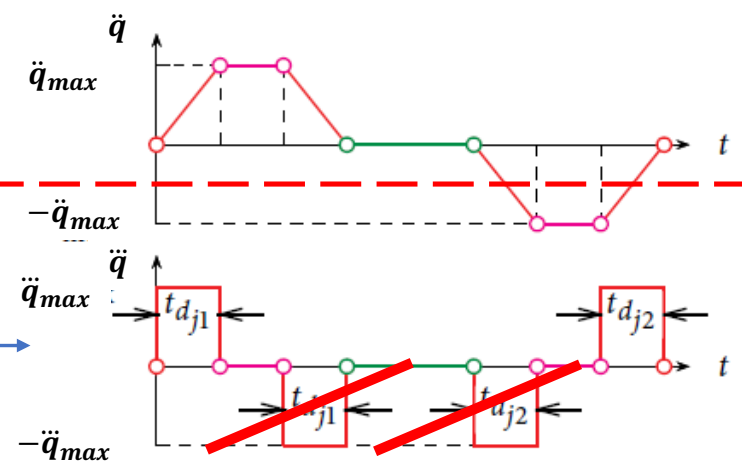
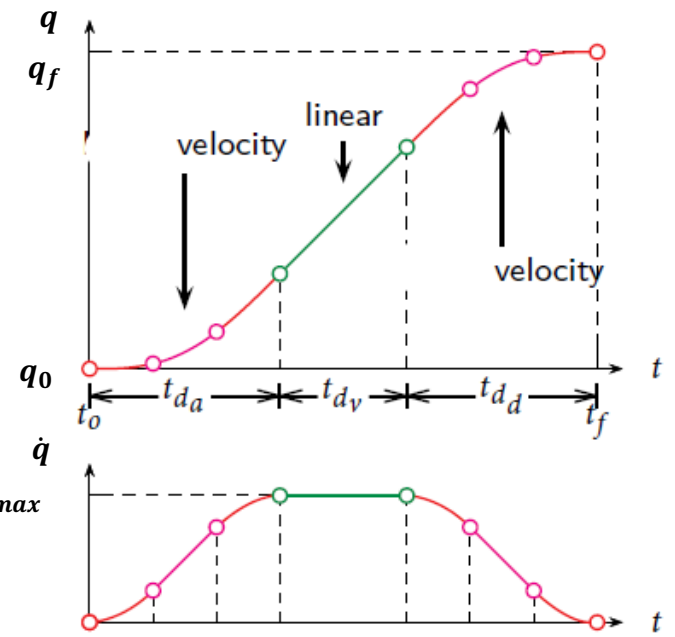
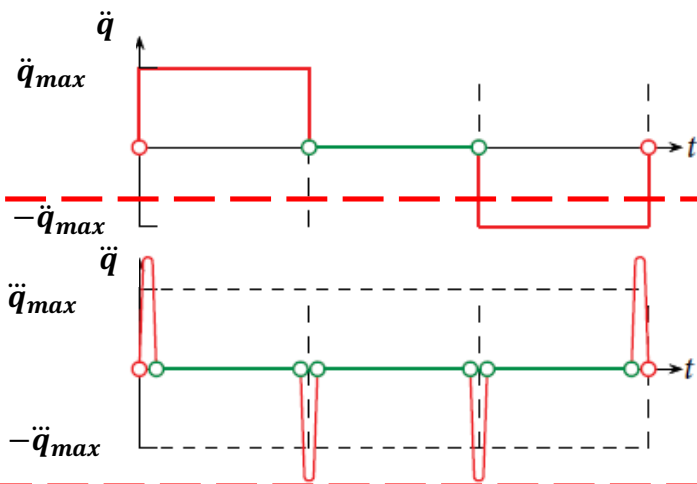


<https://commons.wikimedia.org/w/index.php?curid=46643265>

How does this show?



Introduction of
trapezoidal acc. blend
= S blends [L. Biagiotti
and C. Melchiorri. *Trajectory
Planning for Automatic
Machines and Robots*. Springer
Verlag, 2008]



We are looking for
= polynomial
interpolation

Cubic Polynomial Interpolation

Cubic Polynomial Interpolation

- Cubic polynomial interpolation can be applied in task and joint space.
- Dense here means that we may assume that the displacements between adjacent frames are small.
- In such a case, linear interpolation is generally not suitable because the segments are too small (velocity is not continuous between segments).
- Here, we recommend to use cubic interpolations or splines.

Cubic Polynomial Interpolation

- Cubic interpolation can be used in:
 - joint space, using n-tuple $X_i \equiv q^i$,
 - tool space, using 7-tuple $X_i \equiv (p^i, Q^i)$ for $i = 0, 1, \dots, N$.
- Orientations should be represented as quaternions (don't forget to normalize at the end!!).
- Between two frames (X_{i-1} and X_i) we obtain a curve, defined as:
$$X_{i-1,i}(t) = a_i t^3 + b_i t^2 c_i t + d_i$$
- where parameters a_i, b_i, c_i, d_i have to be determined.
- depending on the number of curves we have $4N$ parameters to determine.

Cubic Polynomial Interpolation

- The curves must satisfy the following constraints

$$X_{i-1,i}(t_{i-1}) = a_i t_{i-1}^3 + b_i t_{i-1}^2 + c_i t_{i-1} + d_i = X_{i-1} \quad i = 1, \dots, N$$

$$X_i(t_i) = a_i t_i^3 + b_i t_i^2 + c_i t_i + d_i = X_i \quad i = 1, \dots, N$$

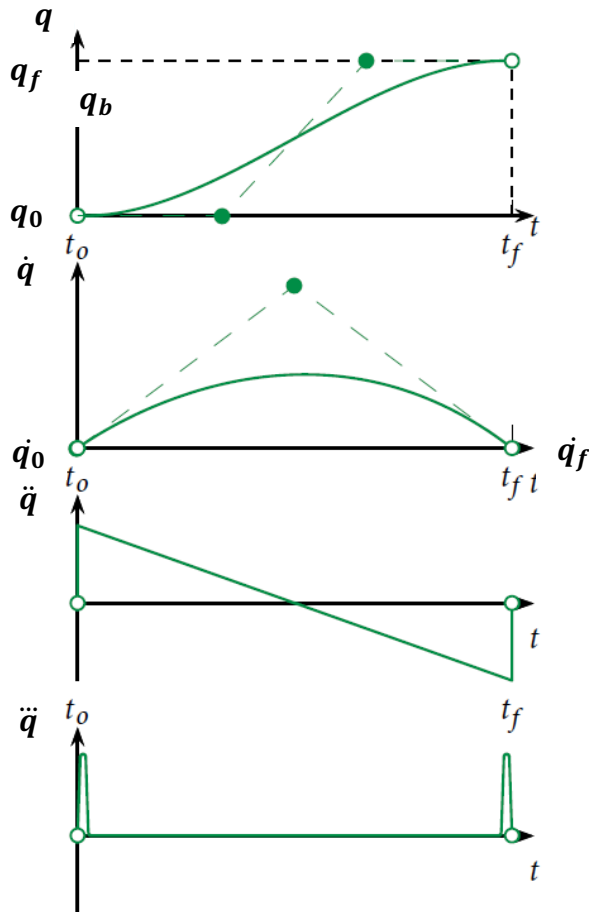
- which gives a 2N linear equations with unknowns,
- the remaining 2N equations can be given in several ways.
- for example if velocities at passage points are given we get

Cubic Polynomial Interpolation

$$\begin{aligned}\dot{X}_{i-1}(t_{i-1}) &= 3a_it_{i-1}^2 + 2b_it_{i-1} + c_i = \dot{X}_{i-1} \quad i = 1, \dots, N \\ \dot{X}_i(t_i) &= 3a_it_i^2 + 2b_it_i + c_i = \dot{X}_i \quad i = 1, \dots, N\end{aligned}$$

- which gives 4 linear equations with 4 unknowns for each sub-path.

Let's take a closer look at this problem...



- Let's consider a cub. interp. between two positions in joint space.
- where 4 parameters a_0, a_1, a_2, a_3 are to be determined by boundary conditions.
- Property: bounded acceleration, jerk impulse at both ends.

$$q(t) = a_0 + a_1(t - t_0) + a_2(t - t_0)^2 + a_3(t - t_0)^3$$

$$t \in [t_0, t_f], t_d \triangleq t_f - t_0$$

$$\begin{cases} q(t_0) = a_0 = q_0 \\ \dot{q}(t_0) = a_1 = \dot{q}_0 \\ q(t_f) = a_0 + a_1 t_d + a_2 t_d^2 + a_3 t_d^3 = q_f \\ \dot{q}(t_f) = a_1 + 2a_2 t_d + 3a_3 t_d^2 = \dot{q}_f \end{cases} \Rightarrow \begin{cases} a_0 = q_0 \\ a_1 = \dot{q}_0 \\ a_2 = \frac{3h - (2\dot{q}_0 + \dot{q}_f)t_d}{t_d^2} \\ a_3 = \frac{-2h + (\dot{q}_0 + \dot{q}_f)t_d}{t_d^3} \end{cases}$$

Multi point cubic interpolation

- Given $q_0, q_f, \dot{q}_0, \dot{q}_f$ at t_0, t_f and via points $[q_k]_1^m$ and $[t_k]_1^m$ where m is the number of sections between the points and k is the number of the specific point, we solve:

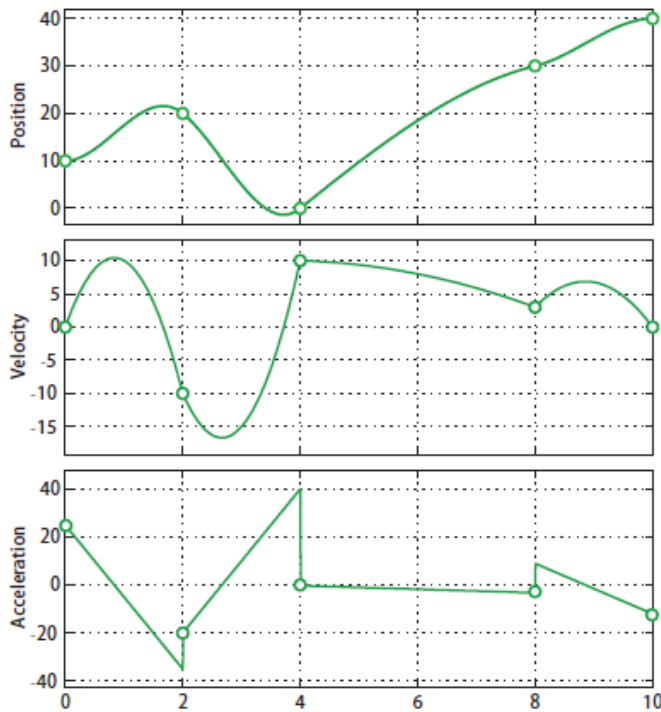
$$a_{0k} + a_{1k}(t - t_k) + a_{2k}(t - t_k)^2 + a_{3k}(t - t_k)^3$$

for all unknowns $\{a_{0k}, a_{1k}, a_{2k}, a_{3k}\}_0^m$.

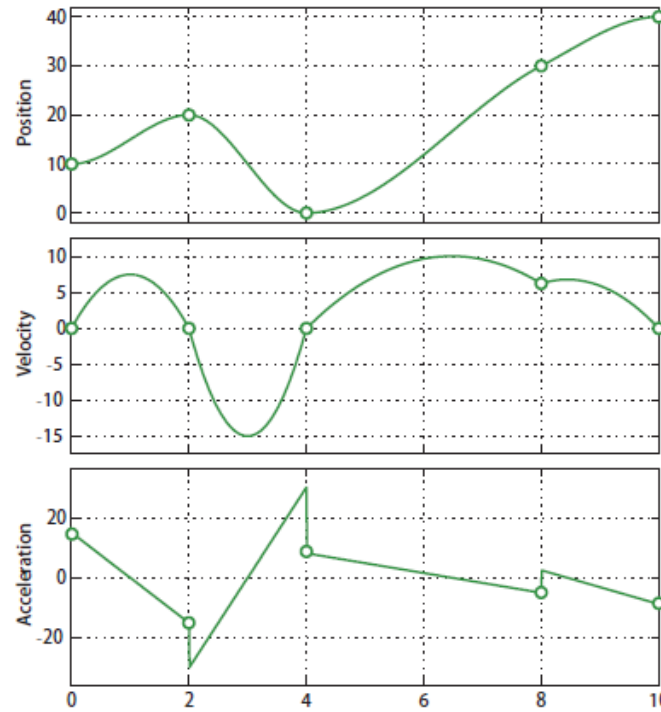
- accelerations at via points can be assigned by the user $[\ddot{q}_k]_1^m$ and $t_d = t_f - t_0, h = q_f - q_0$, we can compute the coefficients.

$$\begin{cases} a_{0k} = q_0 & a_{1k} = \dot{q}_0 \\ a_{2k} = \frac{3h - (2\dot{q}_0 + \dot{q}_f)t_d}{t_d^2} & a_{3k} = \frac{-2h + (2\dot{q}_0 + \dot{q}_f)t_d}{t_d^3}, k = 0, 1, \dots, m \end{cases}$$

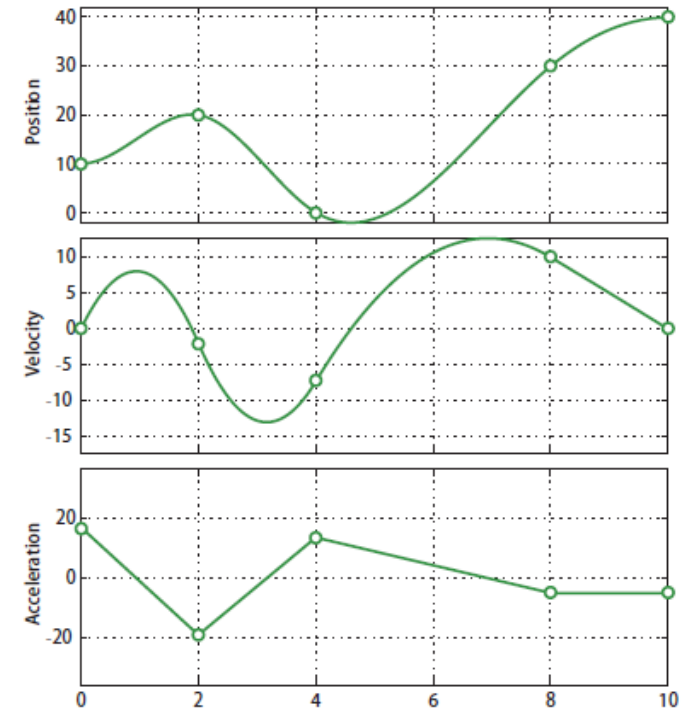
With via points Example:



Via points velocities are arbitrary assigned – large discontinuous acc.



Via points velocities assigned – large discontinuous acc.

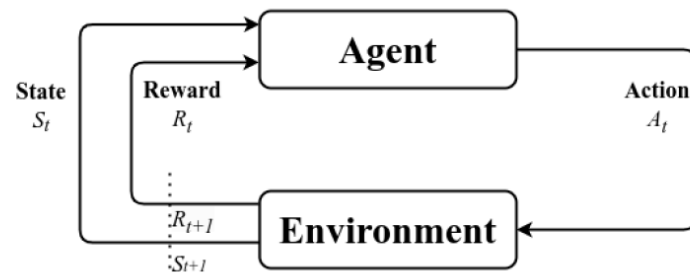


Higher order polynomial – continuous acc.

Defining trajectories with Learning

Training robot policies in simulation

- Training assembly models in Nvidia Factory,
- Testing assembly policies and then moving to the real world,



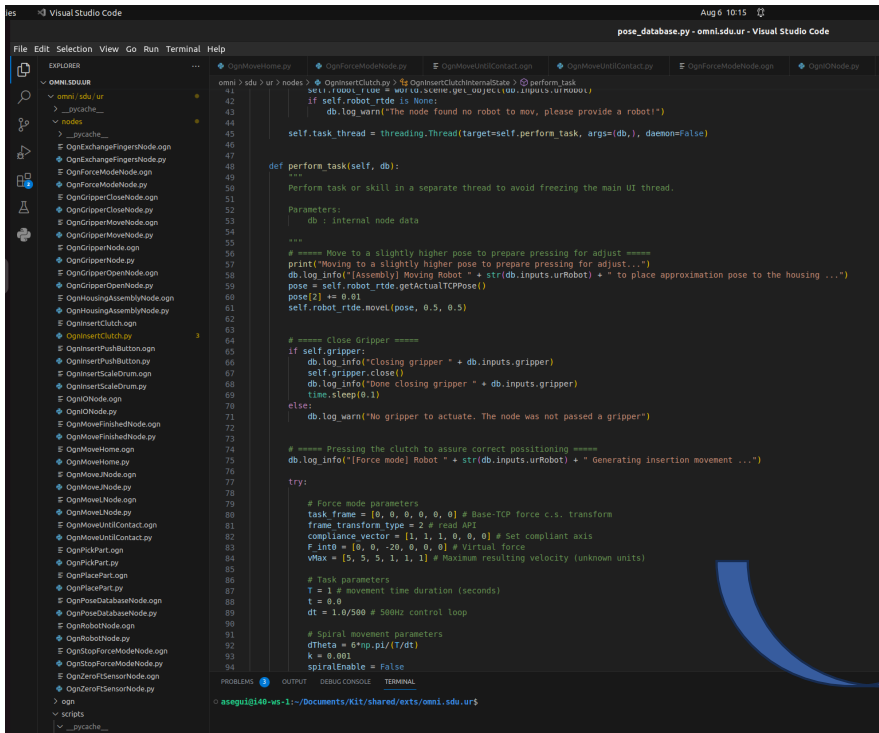
Factory: Fast Contact for Robotic Assembly

Robotics: Science and Systems 2022

V. Averis, R. Storti, I. Alvarez, M. Mordukhai, P. Patel, L. Rosenthal,
V. Stou, A. Mousavizadeh, S. Stou, M. Joo, A. Hilde, D. Fox

From code to “nodes”, by Adrian Aparisi Segui

- Ease robot programming by generating blocks that can be easily dragged and dropped by the non-skilled user.

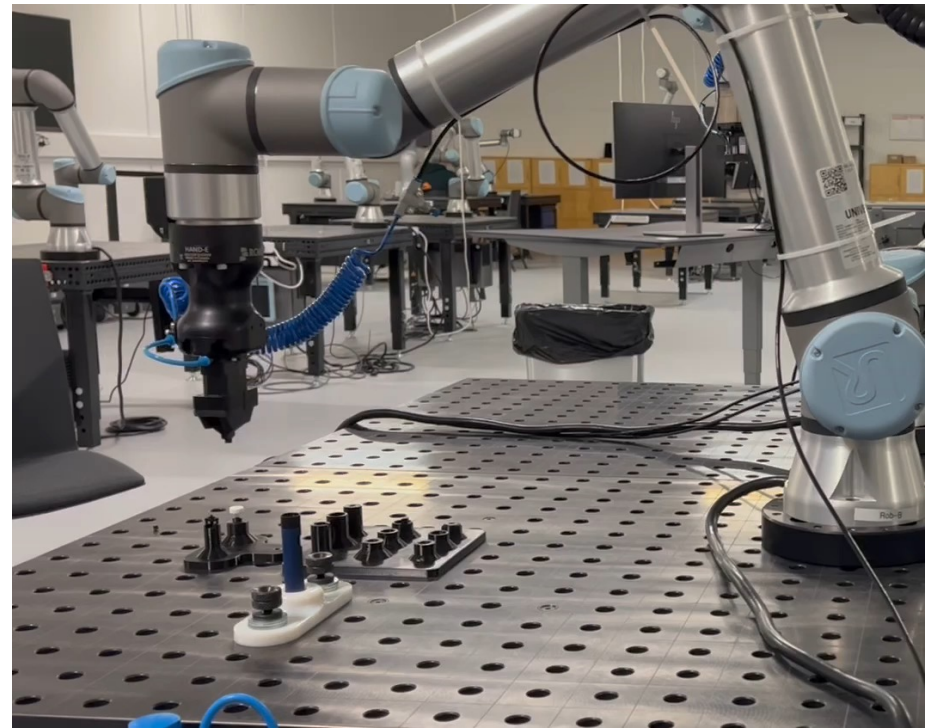
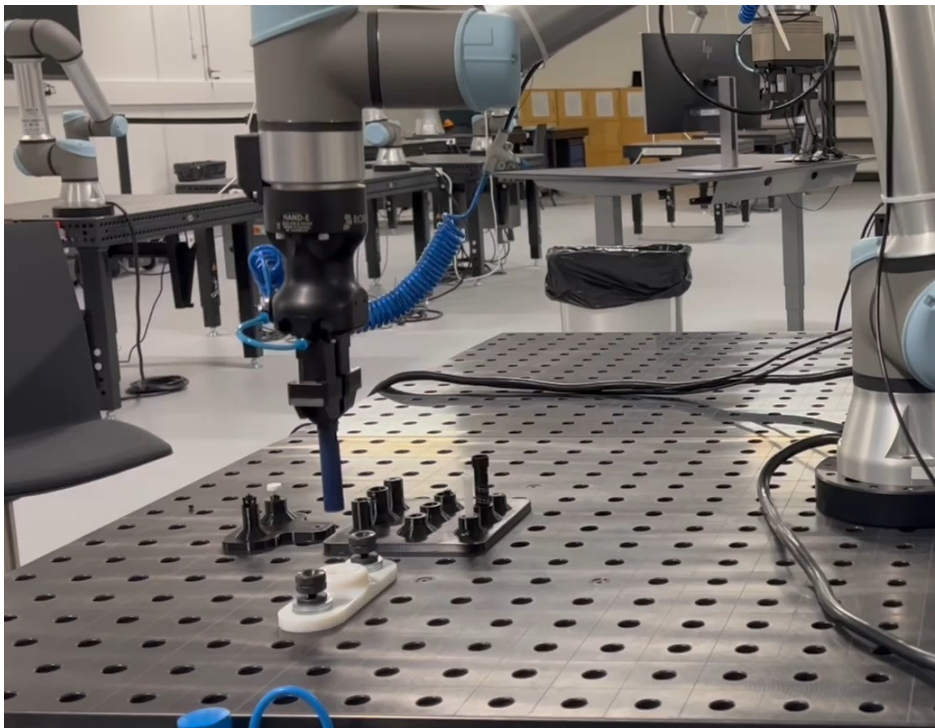


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Force mode for assembly

- Some robots such as UR5e have sensors to measure the force applied to the environment, this allows us to program more complex assembly processes

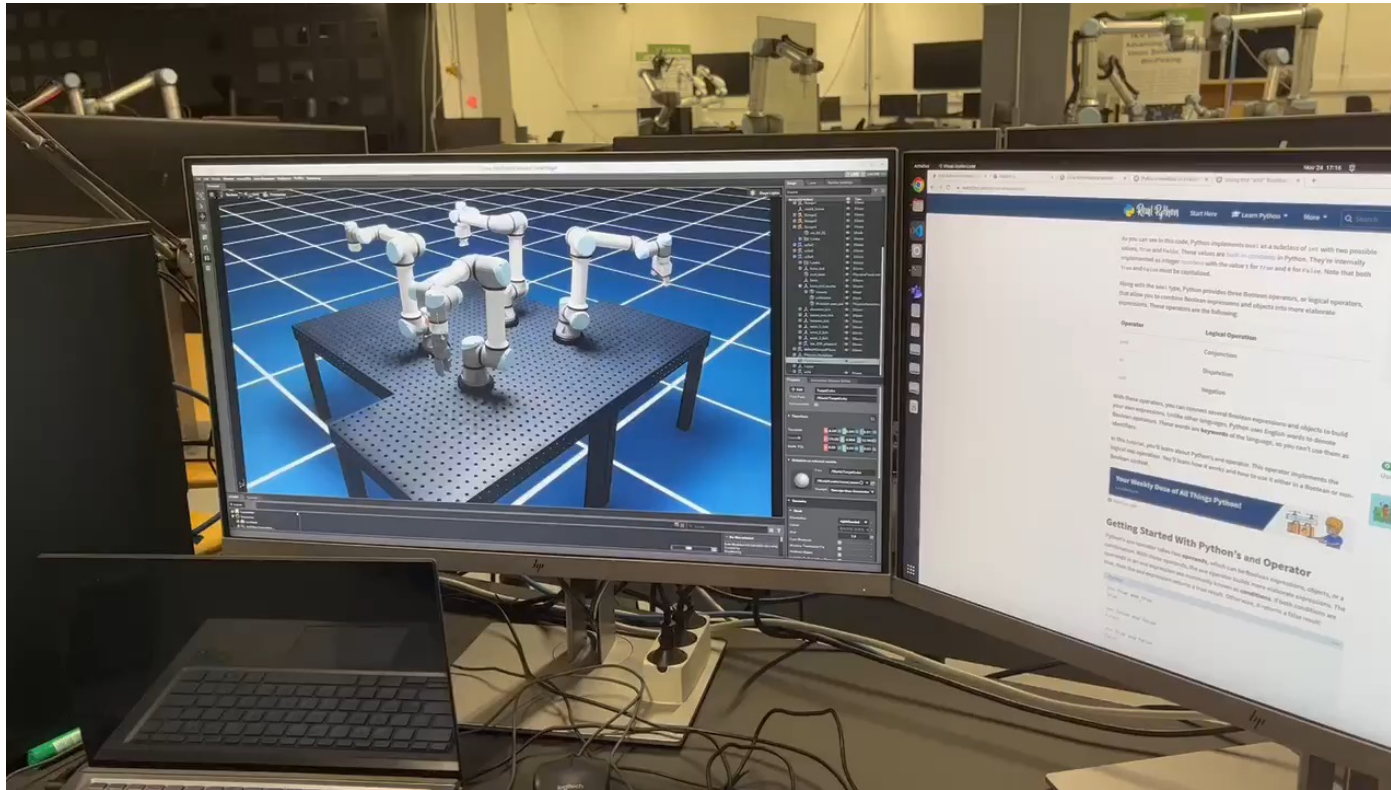


Dynamic simulation of assembly tasks

- Task given by Novo Nordisk:
 - Explore the possibilities of simulation
- NVIDIA Isaac Sim
 - Physics simulation
 - FEM
 - Extensions
- Low volume production
- Assembly design/testing



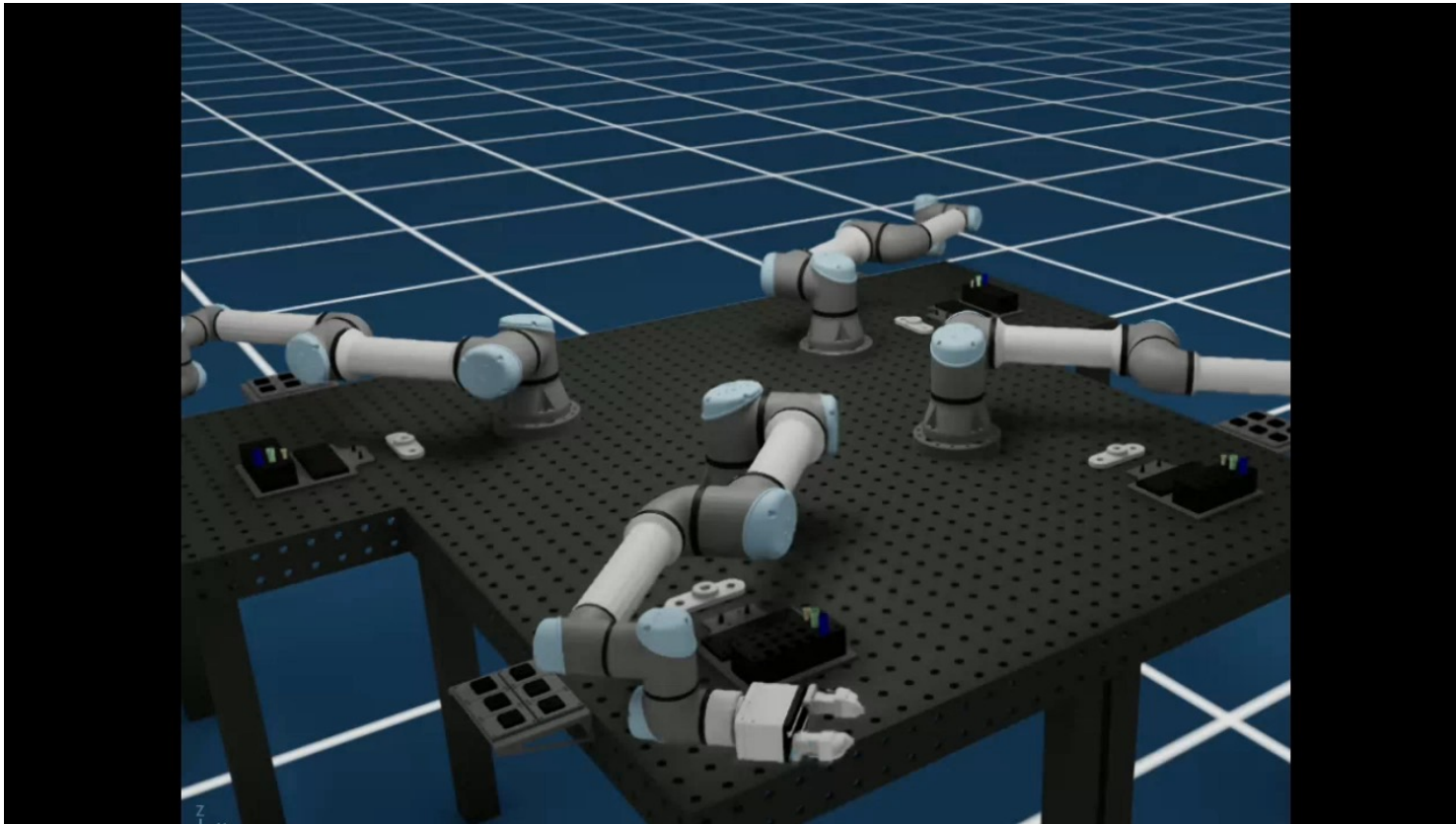
Dynamic simulation of assembly tasks



Dynamic simulation of assembly tasks



Dynamic simulation of assembly tasks



Robotic Grasping

Thanks to:

- J. Li, Grasping lecture, Worcester Polytechnic Institute,
- Berenson, Dmitry, et al. "Grasp planning in complex scenes." *7th IEEE-RAS International Conference on Humanoid Robots*, 2007.

Grasping – is a complex task

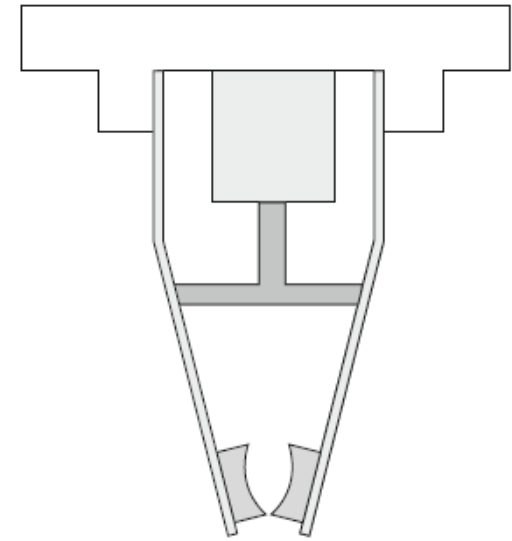
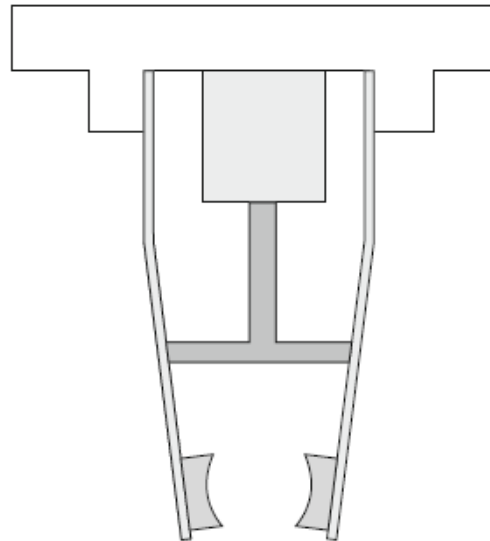
- hand design: high level (number of fingers, kinematic structure, etc.) and low-level (mechanism design, motors, materials, etc.);
- hand control algorithms: high level (find an appropriate posture for a given task) and low-level (execute the desired posture);
- information from sensors (tactile, vision, range sensing, etc.);
- any pre-existing knowledge of objects shape, semantics and tasks (e.g. a cup is likely to be found on a table, should not be held upside-down, etc.);
- all of these add up to a Grasp Planning System...and more!

Human vs. robotic grasping

- Human performance provides both a benchmark to compare against, and a working example that we can attempt to learn from. However, it has proven very elusive to replicate:
- the human hand is a very complex piece of equipment, with amazing capabilities;
- humans benefit from an unmatched combination of visual and tactile sensing;
- human continuously practice grasping and manipulation, the amount of data they are exposed to dwarfs anything tried so far in robotics;

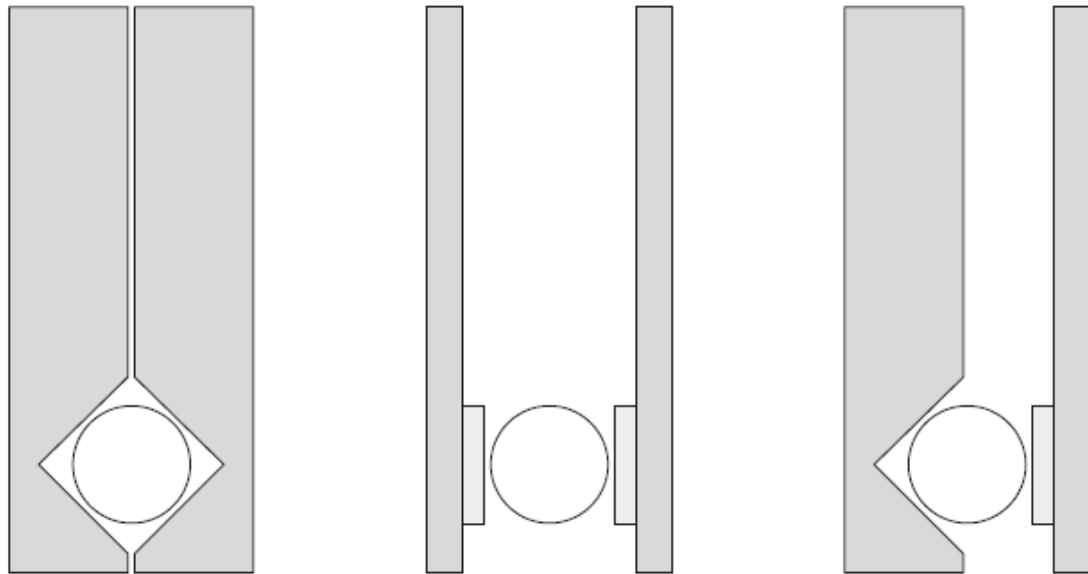
Grasping in industrial robotics

- Grippers with passive spring fingers
- we do not have direct control.



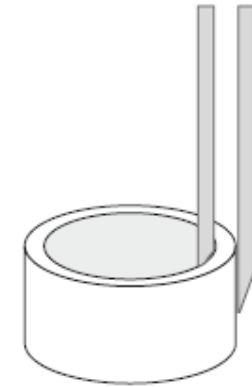
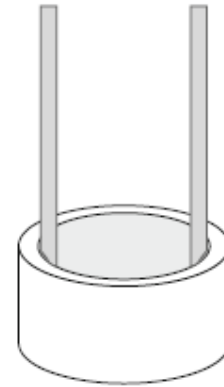
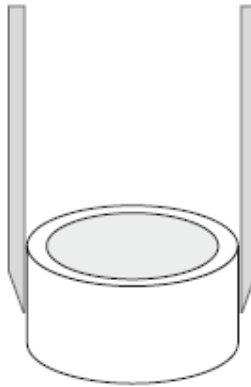
Grasping in industrial robotics

- Form closure, depended on the features of the object and gripper
- Force closure, the movement of the object is restricted based on the applied force, from the gripper.
- combined option



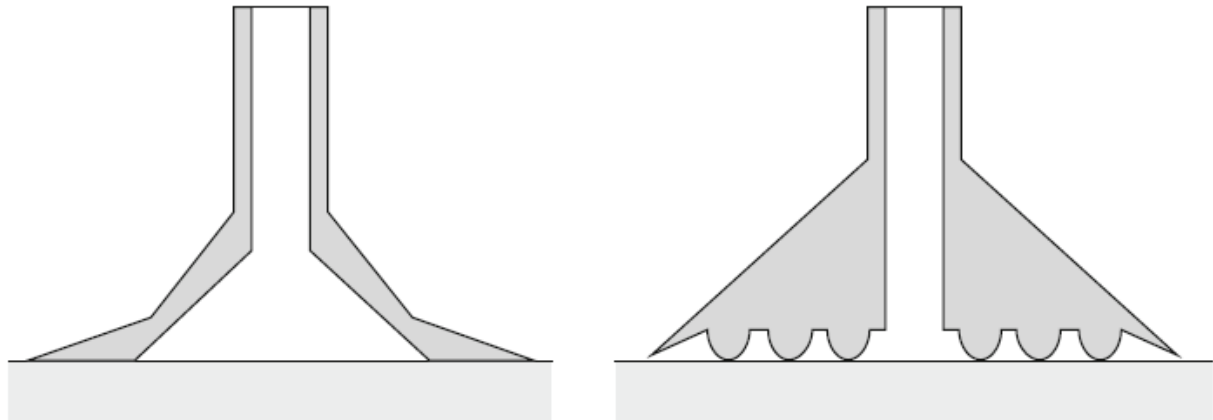
Grasping in industrial robotics

- External grasp
- Internal grasp
- Intermediate grip



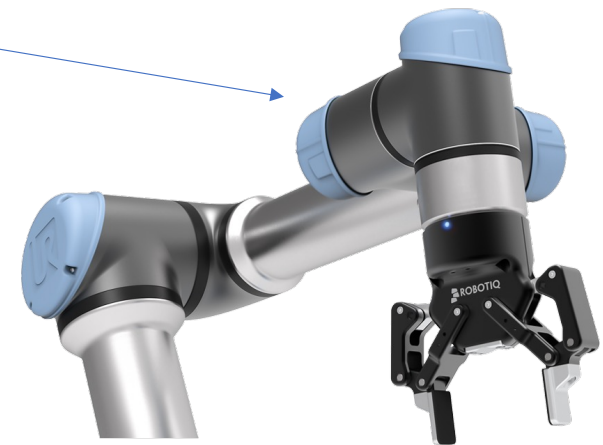
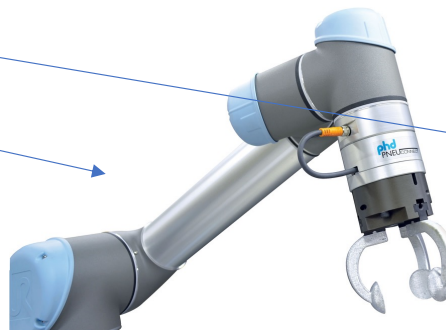
Grasping in industrial robotics

- Vacuum grip, one of the more popular and often implemented methods for object manipulation in industry.



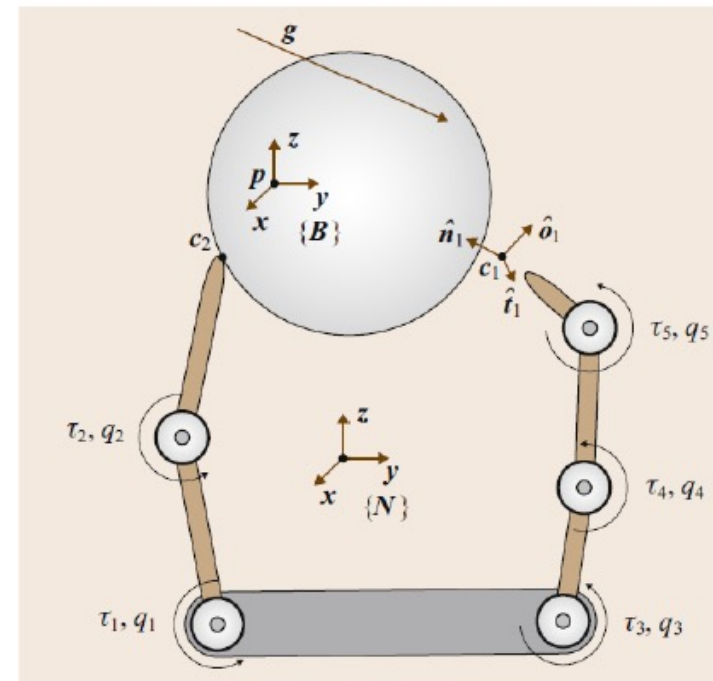
Grippers

- We distinguish several types of grippers:
 - Servo electric,
 - Pneumatic,
 - Vacuum,
 - Jamming,
 - Etc.



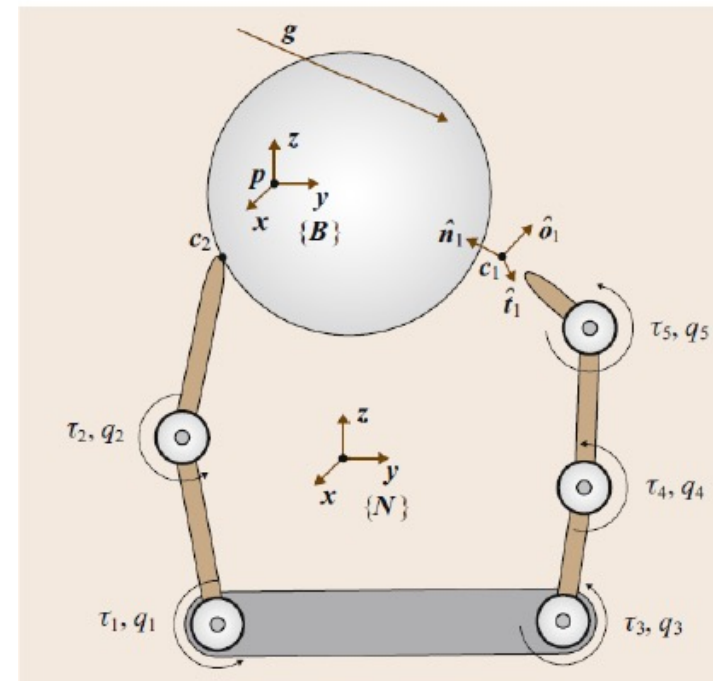
How to define a grasp?

- We have to consider contacts between:
 - Grasping device
 - Object
- The best way to do so is to derive a model.



How to define a grasp?

- With a model we can:
 - Predict the behavior of the hand and object under various loading conditions that may arise during grasping
- Disturbance
 - Inertia force – e.g. fast motion
 - Applied force – e.g. Gravity
- Maintaining a grasp
 - No contact separation
 - No unwanted contact sliding
- Closure grasp
 - The special class of grasps that can be maintained for every possible disturbing load



Model vs real world

A lot of conditions to consider therefore we like to simplify the problem:

- **Real world:** Complex mechanism, soft contacts, soft objects, bounded force.
- **Simplified Problem:** ignore hand mechanism, Assume n point contacts, assume rigid object, assume object is fixed

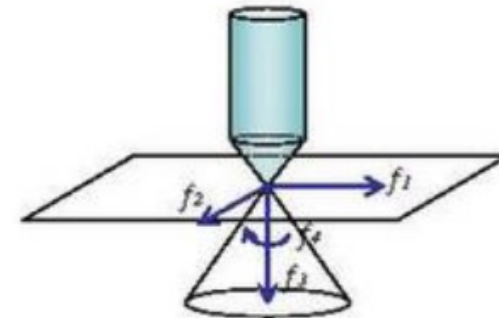
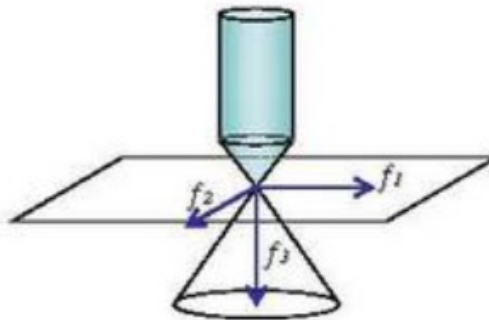
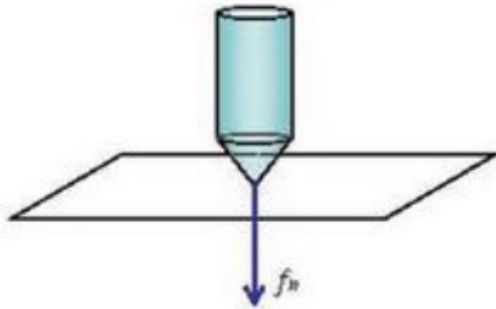
Definition of a point contact

For a one-point contact, we have to consider the following:

- Twist
 - A combination of translational and rotational velocity of the object
$$v_T = [v, \omega]^T$$
- Wrench
 - A combination of the force and torque applied to the object (at object origin)
$$g = [f, m]^T$$
- Wrench space
 - Space of wrenches applied to the object
 - 3D: 6 dimensional wrench space (3 force, 3 torque)
 - 2D: 3 dimensional wrench space (2 force, 1 torque)

Contacts

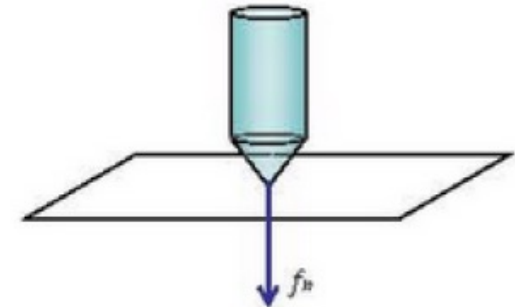
- Point contact without friction
- Hard finger
- Soft finger



Contact modeling

Point contact without friction

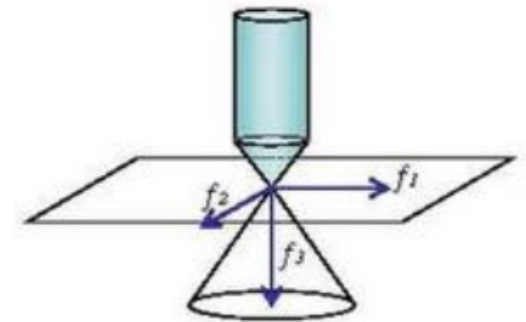
- Contact properties
 - Contact patch is small
 - Contact surface is slippery - no surface friction
- Transmitted to the object
 - Normal component of the translational velocity
 - Normal component of the contact force



Contact modeling

Hard Finger

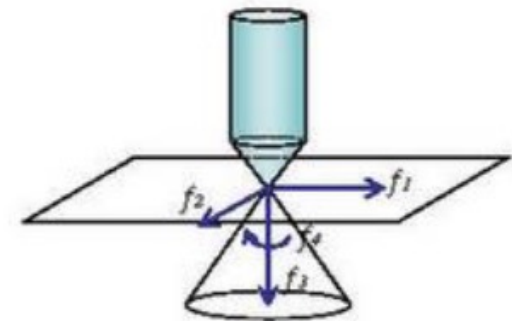
- Contact properties (friction force, but no appreciable friction moment)
 - Small contact patch
 - Large enough surface friction
- Transmitted to the object
 - All three components of the translational velocity
 - All three components of the contact force
 - No angular velocity or moment



Contact modeling

Soft Finger (SF)

- Contact properties (appreciable friction moment)
 - Large enough contact patch
 - Large enough surface friction
- Transmitted to the object
 - All three components of the translational velocity
 - All three components of the contact force
 - Normal component of contact moment



Contact modeling

Friction cone

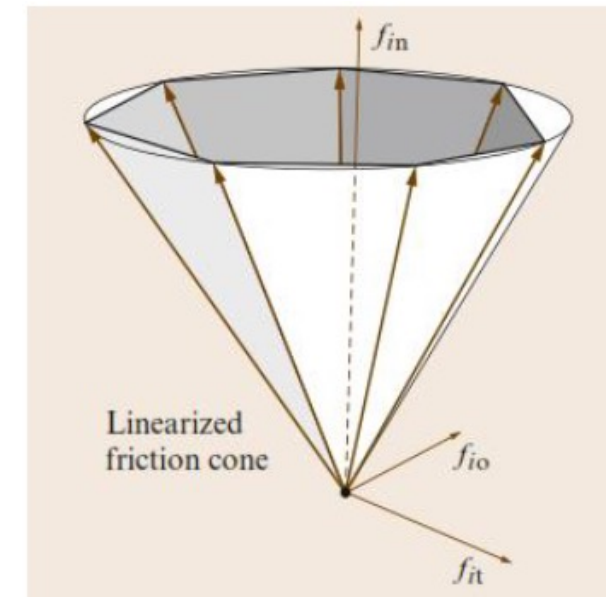
- The set of forces that can be applied at a contact point without sliding on the object
- Friction cone for i th contact point is the set

$$\mathcal{F}_i = \{(f_{in}, f_{it}, f_{io}) \mid \sqrt{f_{it}^2 + f_{io}^2} \leq \mu_i f_{in}\}$$

- f_{in} is the force applied normal to the surface
- f_{io} and f_{it} are the forces applied along the surface

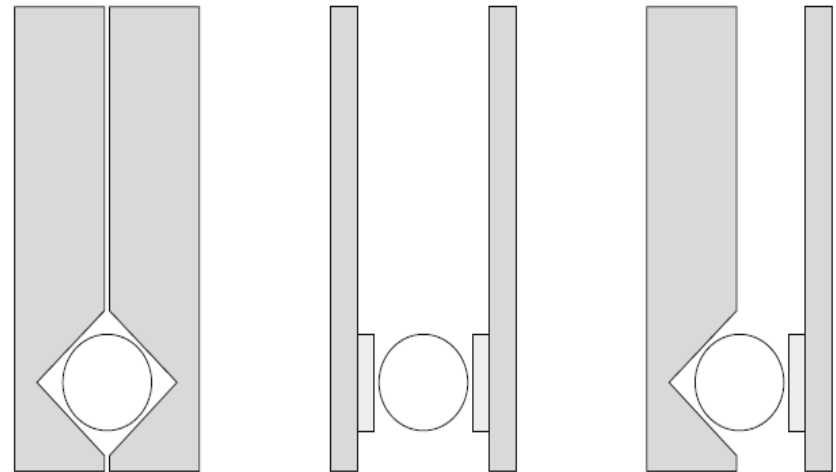
Note:

- Coulomb friction
- Depends on coefficient of friction between hand and object
- Bigger μ implies wider friction cone



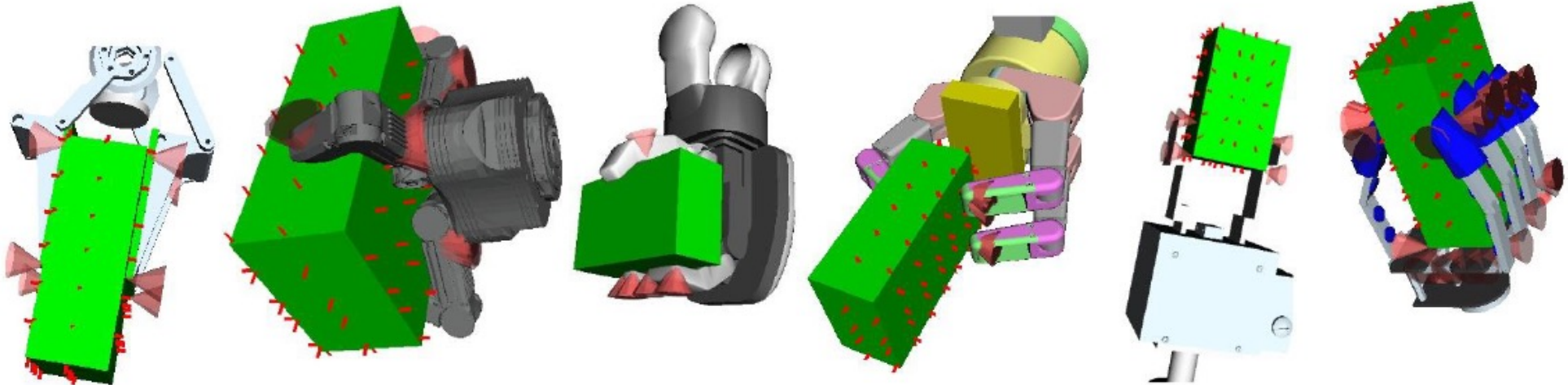
Grasping in industrial robotics

- Form closure, depended on the features of the object and gripper
 - You need at least $N+1$ contacts to achieve first-order form closure, where N is the number of DOF of the object
- Force closure, the movement of the object is restricted based on the applied force and friction material properties.
- combined option



Grasp planning

- Grasp planning can be calculated based on a set of precomputed set of stable grasps



Grasp planning

This concept is not new,

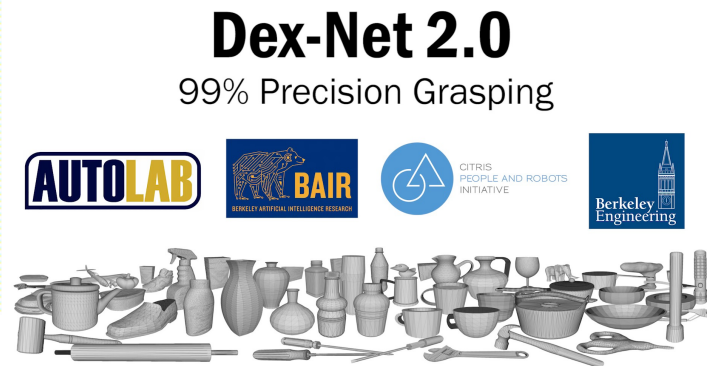
- Extensive grasping databases exists: <http://grasping.cs.columbia.edu/>
- Reuse the 3D models from the Princeton Shape Benchmark (PSB)
 - Well known academic dataset of 1,814 models
 - All models resized to “graspable” sizes
 - PSB models were not originally selected with an eye towards robotic grasping
 - Some of the models are not obvious choices for grasping experiments.
- Provide grasps at 4 scales
 - ...because grasping is scale dependent
 - .75, 1.0, 1.25 and 1.5 times the size of each model
 - 7,256 3D models in all

Other approaches

- Using learning to find the appropriate grasp for a defined object
 - GraspNet-1Billion <https://graspnet.net/tasks.html>
 - DexNet https://berkeleyautomation.github.io/dex-net/#dexnet_21



https://graspnet.net/images/120_pred.gif



https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=i6K3GI2_EgU



<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GBiAxoWBNho&t=17s>

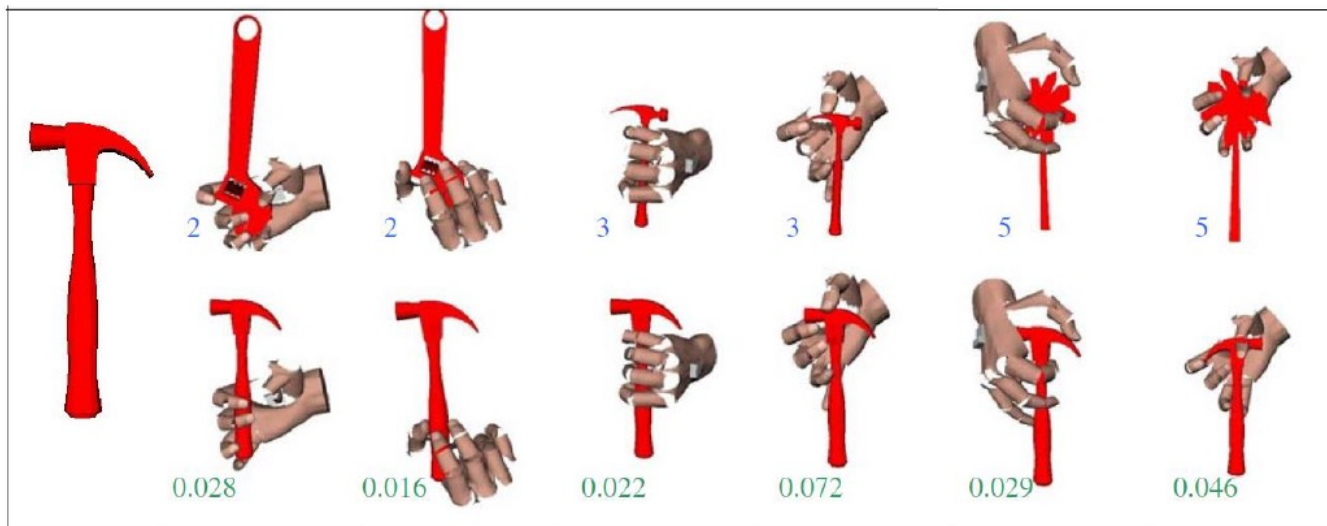
Grasp planning

A grasp based on the database is computed as:

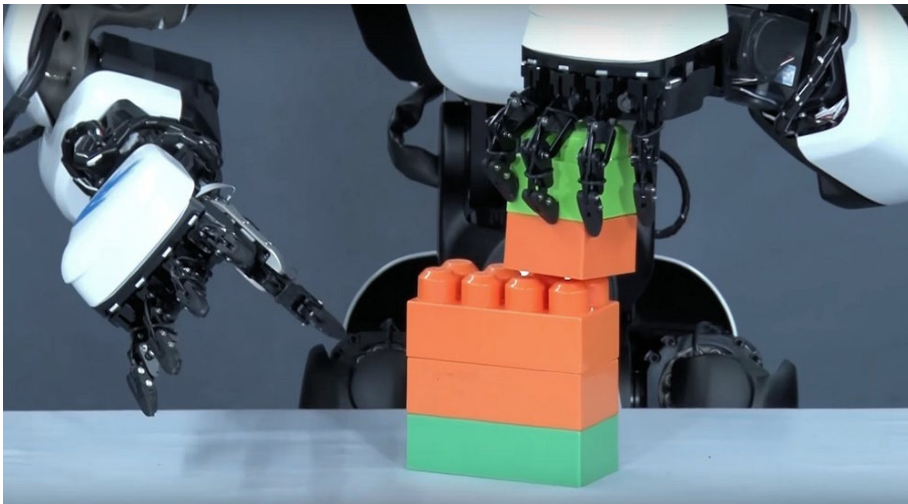
- Shape matching, collocating and grasp computing

Performance

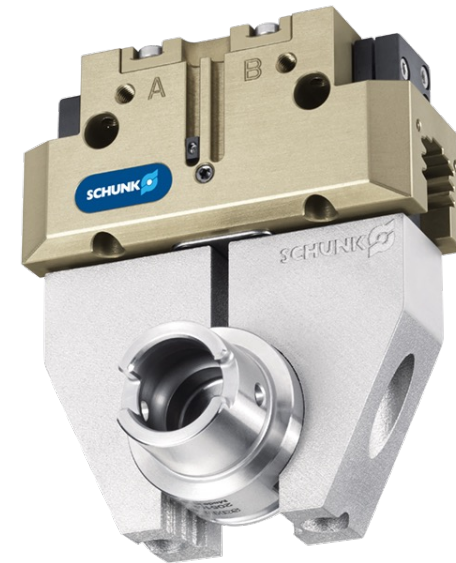
- 20 seconds, from shape matching to final output



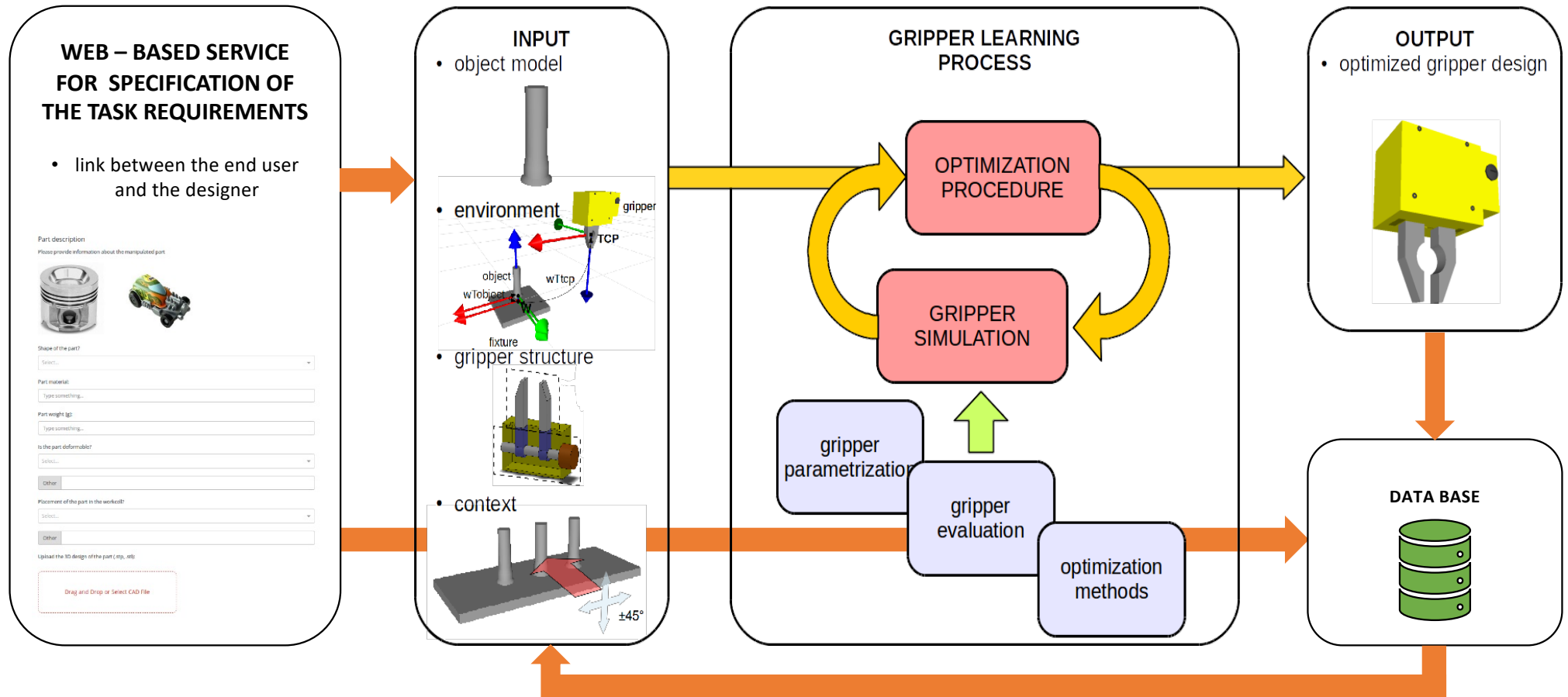
Industrial grasping



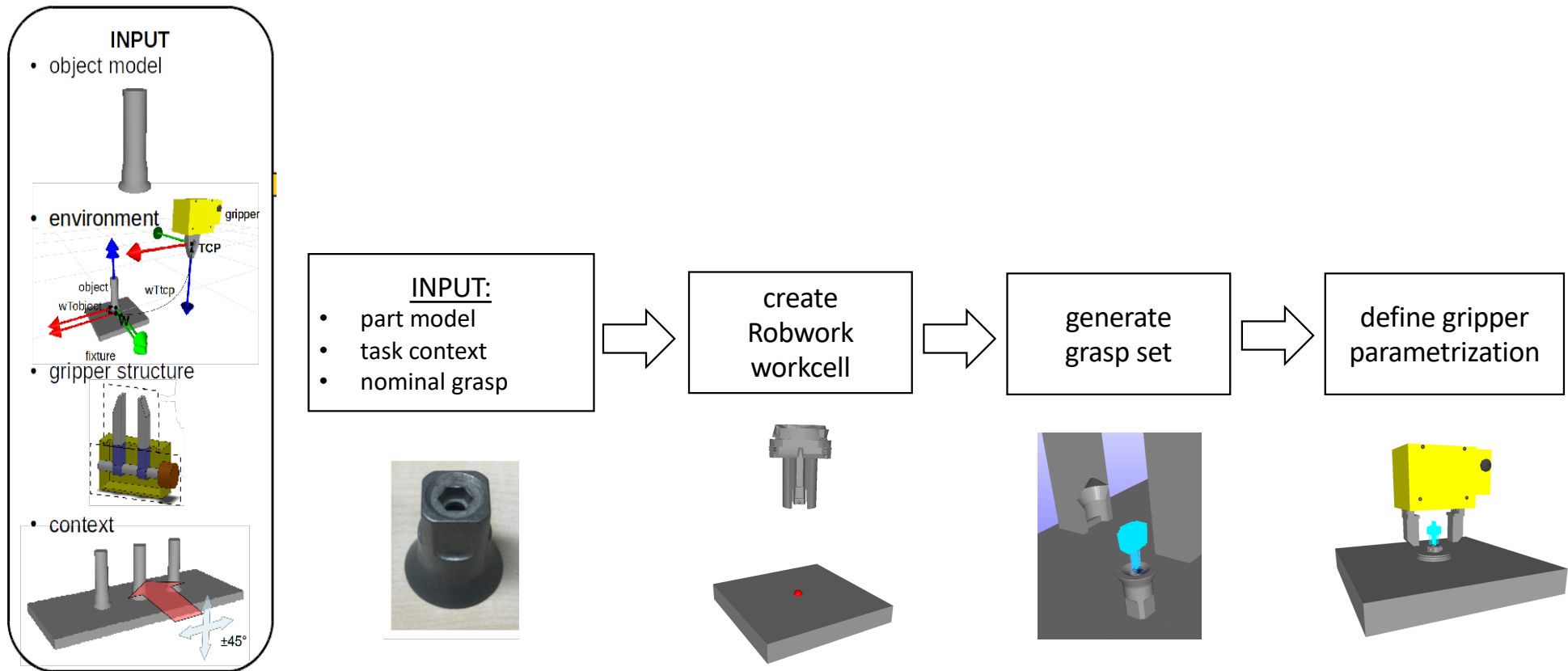
Dexterous grippers for industrial assembly

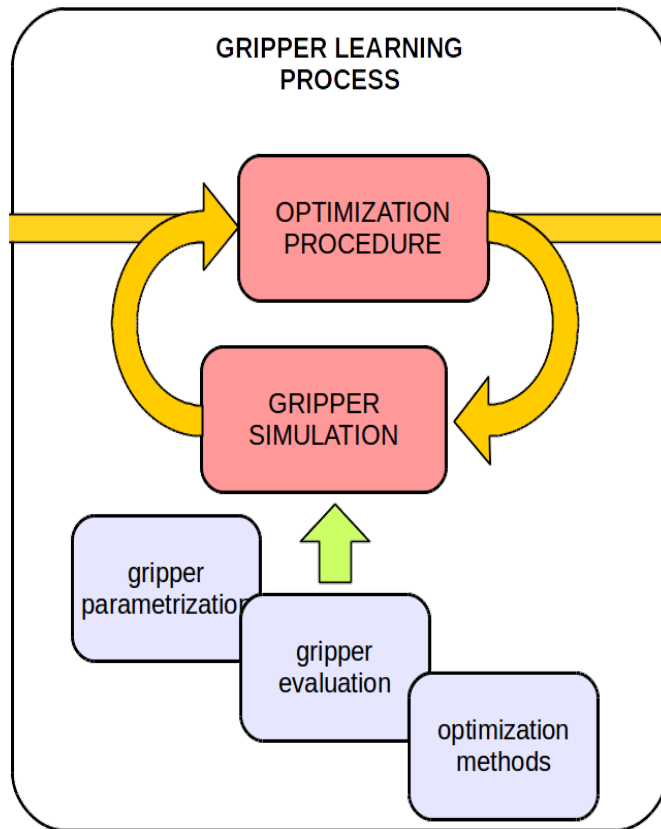


Task specific grippers for industrial assembly

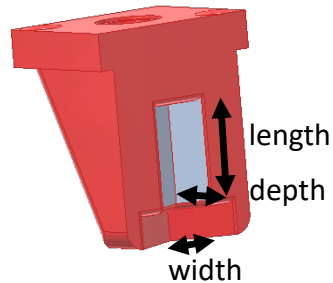


Design process setup based on the gathered information

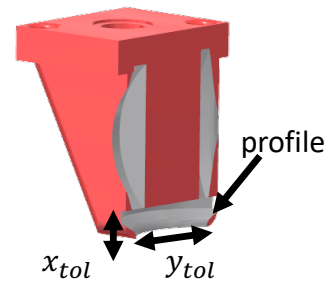




Parameterized design



Imprint design

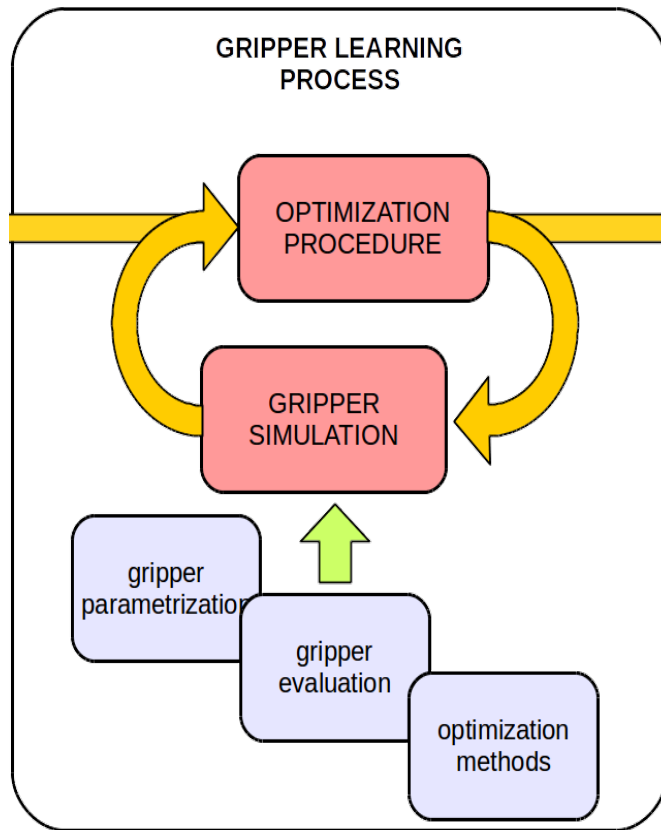


- **Parameterized design:**

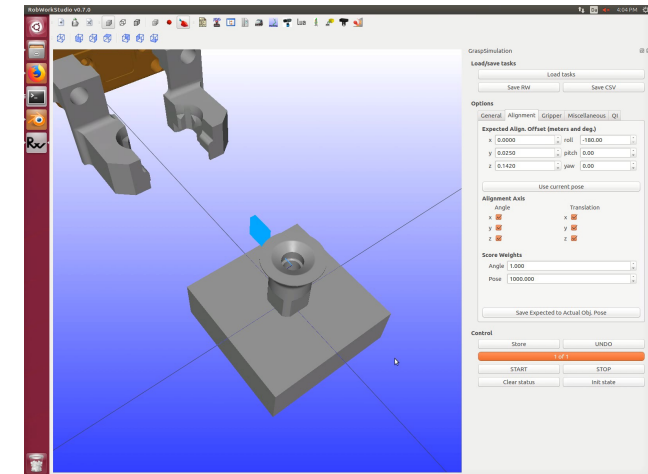
- Geometrical parameters, are used to define the cut-outs of the base finger shape.
- Limited to simple parameters which can be simply measured.

- **Imprint design:**

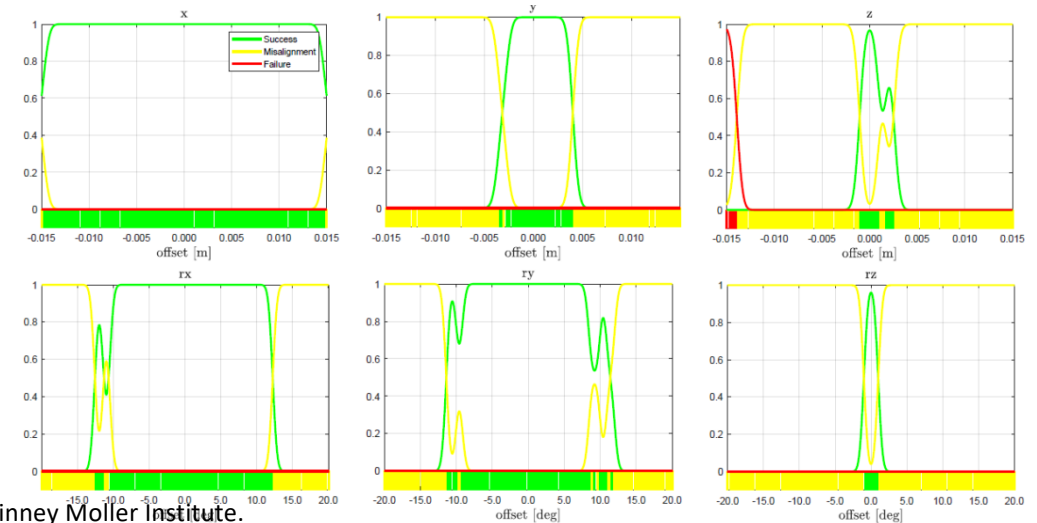
- The method is based on extracting the geometrical features of the manipulated object and transferring them to the base finger shape.
- Smoothing parameters are used for shape alteration.



- **Success Index S** – the percentage of successfully executed grasps
- **Robustness Index R** – gripper performance in the presence of the process noise
- **Alignment Index A** – the gripper ability to force predictable poses on the grasped object
- **Coverage Index C** – the gripper versatility in approaching the object
- **Wrench Index W** – how secure the grasps executed by the gripper are

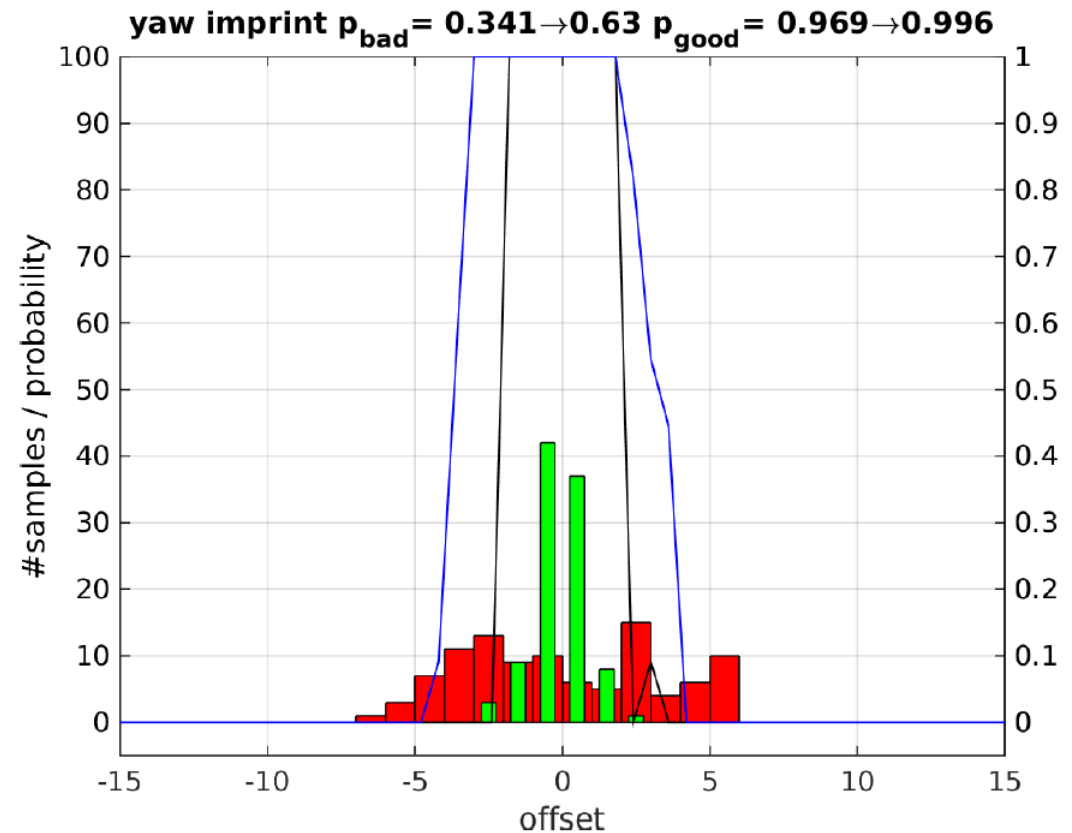


Dynamic testing results

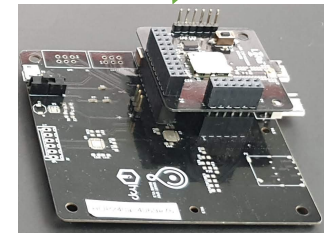
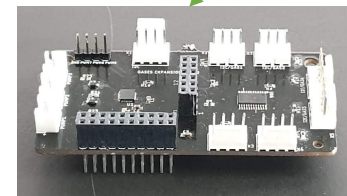
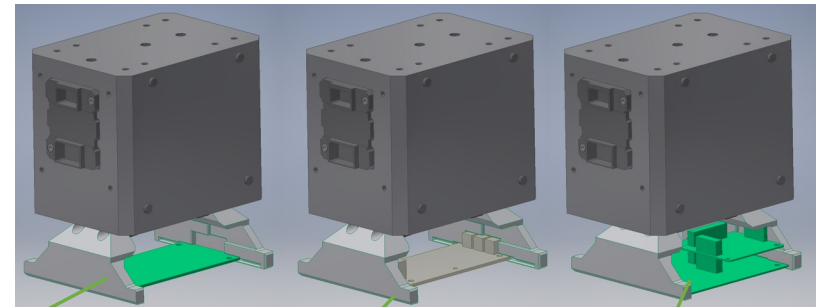
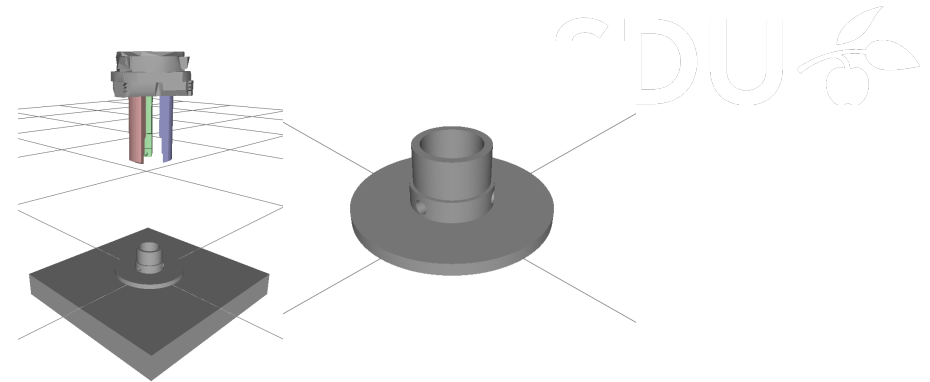
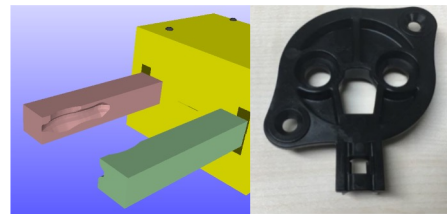
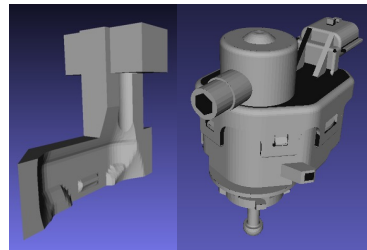
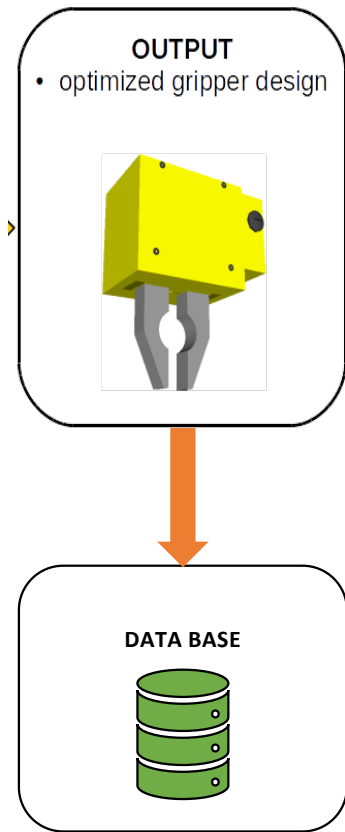


Optimization

- Depending on the design and simulation outcomes, the fingers shape may not be optimal for the specific use-case.
- To achieve optimality, we apply an numeric optimization process, to refine the initial design.
- The process changes and simulate the design parameters in an iterative manner, until the desired performance is achieved.



Some design examples



Thank you for your attention

